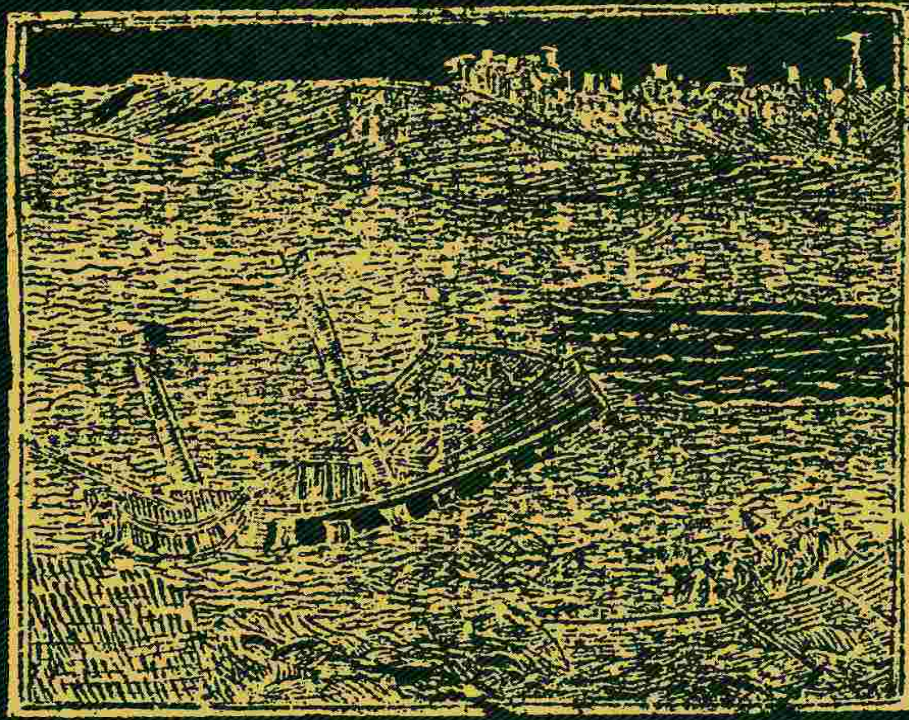
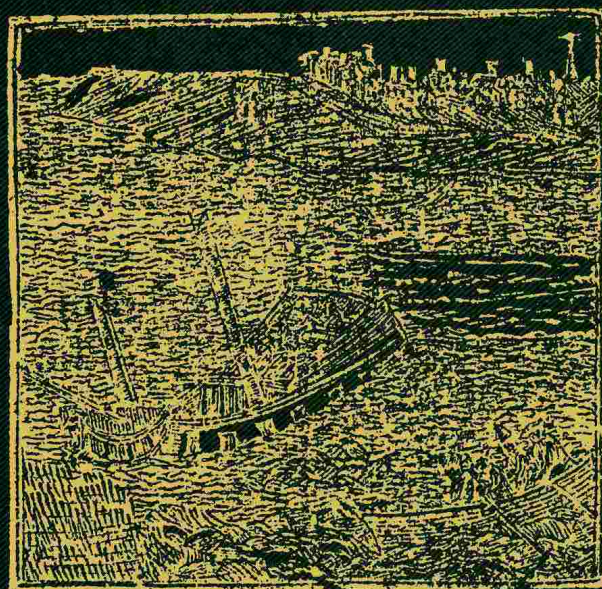




A brief and remarkable
NARRATIVE
O F T H E
L I F E
And extreme Sufferings of
BARNABAS DOWNS, Jun.



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Author: Barnabas Downs

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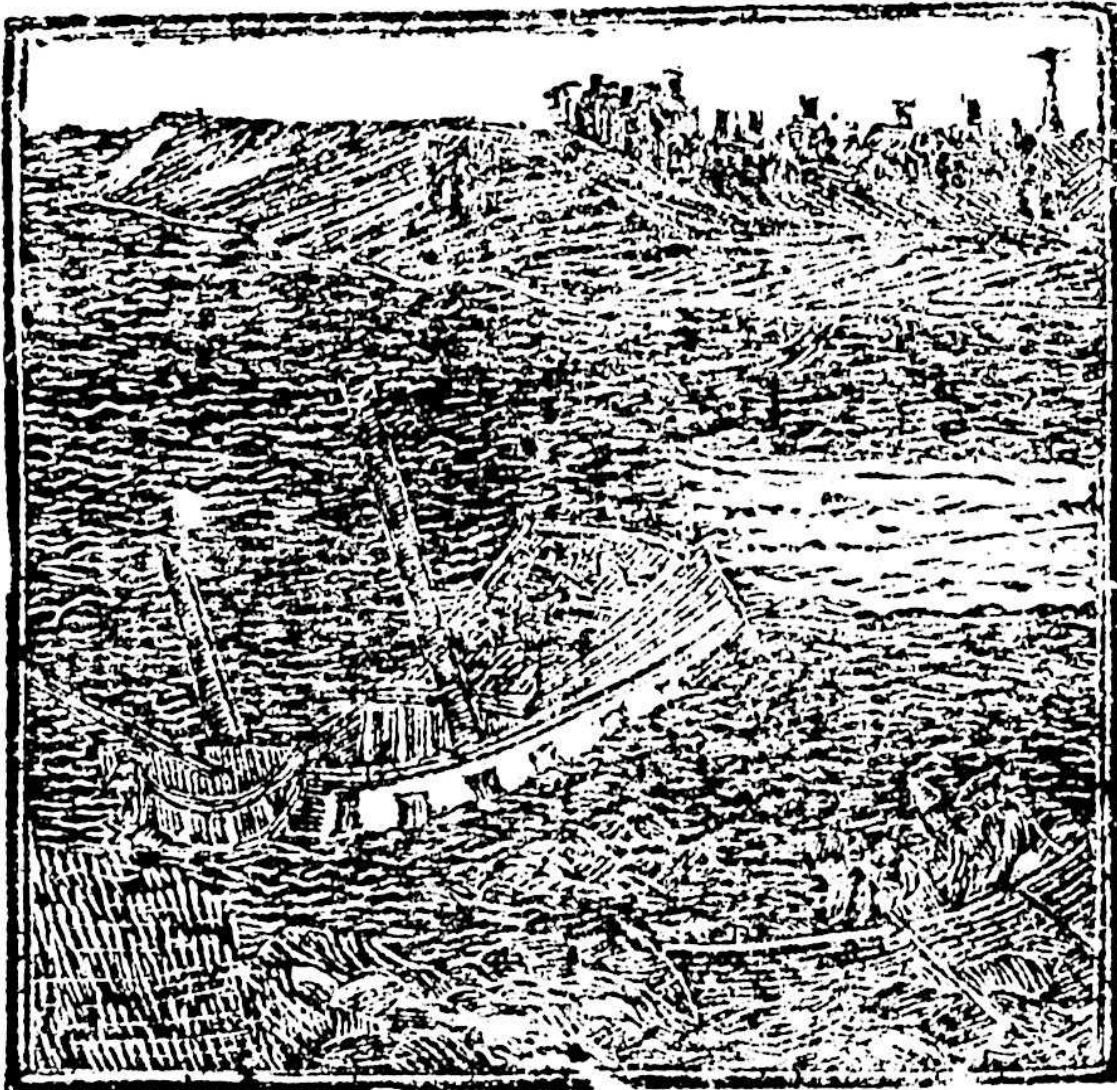
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A particular ACCOUNT of said Shipwreck.

Printed by E. RUSSELL, for the AUTHOR, 1786

PRINTING-OFFICE LIBERTY-SQUARE, Sept. 22, 1786.

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B I C K E R S T A F F's
G E N U I N E A N D C O R R E C T
B O S T O N A L M A N A C K,
For the Year of our REDEMPTION, 1787.

Which will contain a great Variety of useful and entertaining MATTER, in PROSE and VERSE.

This WORK will be likewise ornamented with a large Number of engraved Plates, some of which represent the twelve Signs of the Zodiack in Miniature, and the several Employments and Diversions of the GENTLEMEN FARMERS, throughout the different Seasons of the Year:—Also a curious Representation of a COUNTY CONVENTION, debating on State-Affairs; at the Head of the Table is a Figure of *H O N E S T U S*, that renowned Champion and bold Attestor of the LIBERTY of the Subject, and sworn Enemy to LAWYERS, who is conversing with one of the Order; over his Head is a Label with these Words “No COURTS, no L A W Y E R S:” Another Plate represents a very curious and droll Scene of a large Group of the BLACK ORDER, or

the SONS of LITTLETON and COKE, mounted on Jack-Asses, Peacocks,
&c. returning from a rich Feast at CONCORD COURT, &c.

PREFACE.

*To the R E A D E R, into whose Hands
this N A R R A T I V E may fall;
especially my Seafaring B R E T H -
R E N.*

F R I E N D S,

 WHEN any remarkable circumstances take place in a man's life, he feels commonly a disposition to communicate them to the world: If they have been deliverances from great and signal dangers, he will make this communication from a principle of gratitude to the BEING who hath protected and preserved him: He will wish to engage others to be thankful on his behalf; and a knowledge of the kindness of Heaven to him may lead others to trust in GOD,

when they are brought into like distrefs
and danger. By these motives the Subject
of the following pages hopes he is
influenced in publishing them to the
world; which is all the apology that may
be expected from the P U B L I C K's
distressed Friend,

B A R N. D O W N E S, Jun.

BARNSTABLE, Septem-
ber 10, 1786.

)

☞ *The Author gratefully acknowledges
himself indebted to a Reverend
G E N T L E M A N in Boston for his*

*kindness in correcting the following
sheets.*

A
N A R R A T I V E, &c.

✠+✠+✠ WAS born in *Barnstable*, in *New-England*, October 2, 1757, of credible
✠ I ✠ Parents, whom I served as an obedient
✠+✠+✠ Son, I hope, until the commencement
of the late war called me from my home, and led
me to exchange the occupation of a Husbandman,
to which I was bred for the more dangerous
employment of a Soldier. In this capacity I served
my Country 3 campaigns, and know not that my
behaviour was censured by my officers.

AFTER having returned for a time to the
Farming-Business, I concluded to try my fortune
at sea: I entered accordingly on board the
schooner *Bunker-Hill*, Captain *Isaac Cobb*,
Commander, on a privateering voyage: But we
had not been out more than 6 days before we
were taken by the brig *Hope*, one *Brown*,

Commander, and carried into *Halifax*. We were committed to jail and kept very short: Then I was taken with the small-pox, thro' which GOD safely carried me when destitute of the necessaries of life, and under great pressure of mind. But after my being recovered so far as to be returned to the jail from the hospital, in consequence of my having nothing but a small allowance of salt provisions, which were next to poison for a sick person, I was taken with a violent fever, which returned me again to the hospital, and brought me to the gates of the grave. No person who hath not experienced it can imagine how gloomy and distressing it is to be under such circumstances: To be far distant from our dearest Friends; to be among persons who are not only without any concern for us, or interest in our fate, but who are our professed enemies, and not governed even by the common principles of humanity, is a case truly melancholy. In this situation I was attacked with a bleeding of the nose, (to which I had before been subject) which brought me to the very borders of eternity!

AFTER this I was, by the smiles of heaven recovered and restored, by a cartel, with 400 of my Countrymen to our own homes. How welcome they were to us, and how pleasant it was to me to see the faces of my Friends again, any one may imagine more easily than I can describe!

BUT tho' I had been so unsuccessful in my first attempt at sea, I could not resist the inclination I had to try once more what Providence would do for me: I left my native place, went to *Boston*, and entered on board the brig *Arnold*, *James Magee*, Commander. I well remember I felt an unusual dejection when I entered on this undertaking; and tho' I pretend not to say that this foreboded the misfortunes I was to meet with in this fatal vessel, yet I have often reflected upon it since with a degree of admiration.

WHILE the brig lay in the harbour, I attempted with some other hands to go on board another vessel in a small boat, but the wind suddenly rising we were in danger of being drowned; the boat run on *Governor's-Island*, and we were obliged to stay there 24 hours before we could get off. Providence preserved my life in this danger, in

order that I might live thro' greater, and testify to his loving kindness and mercy.

ON December 24, 1778, Capt. *Magee* sailed from *Boston*: We had been at sea but a few hours, when a most terrible gale of wind arose, so that the water was almost knee deep on the leeward side of the quarter-deck. We continued in the Bay that day and the night following, but on the next day we got into *Plymouth*. The wind was abated, but the cold was severe and intense beyond description. We came to anchor a little below *Beach-Point*, in the Harbour of *Plymouth*.

ON Saturday, December 26, about 6 o'clock in the morning, from the violent motion of the sea, the brig struck the bottom as tho' it would drive her keel in. As there was not depth of water enough to work the vessel in the place where we lay, and we saw a heavy storm coming on, our Commander thought it best to cut our cables and let her drive, which was immediately done. The storm increased very fast, so that we were obliged to cut away the main-mast, and we drifted upon an hard flat a little to the westward of *Beach-Point*.

THIS was early on Saturday morning, and we now laboured hard in throwing over our wood and getting our guns off the decks into the hold, but the vessel began to leak very fast, and with every motion of the sea she struck the bottom as tho' she would split in pieces. We kept 2 pumps going, but could not gain upon the water. The storm now increased to a most prodigious degree: It snowed so thick that we could see but a very little way from the brig, and the cold was extreme; we continued hard at work all day without eating or drinking any thing scarcely, having but little appetite with the prospect of death continually before our eyes.

UNTIL now we had hopes of escape, but just before night we looked into the hold and saw the casks floating about; this drove us to despair, and we forsook the pumps without a ray of hope but from the immediate interposition of divine Providence. Many of the people now began to pray, and I went into the cabin and sat upon one of the gun-carriages. I had not been there long before I saw chests floating about, and perceived that the tide was flowing on us very fast; by

direction of the Capt. all left the cabin and came upon the quarter-deck.

IT is not possible to describe my sensations at this period; death appeared inevitable, and we waited every moment for its approach! Even now, when I recollect my feelings it is difficult to steady my pen! And indeed I had ground enough for my apprehensions, for we had not been long upon the quarter-deck before the water upon the main-deck was even with it. Our fore-mast was still standing, which caused the vessel to roll very much, but when we had cut that away she lay stiller. The brig now lay sunk; the tide was flowing fast and the sea broke very heavily over us. We were all upon the quarter-deck, and the water came in upon us ankle deep.

THERE was a sail in the netting upon the windward-quarter, which we contrived to lash over us, but there were so many under it that we should have been stifled for want of breath, if we had not cut places to let in the air. The tide was then about at its height but the storm did not abate. There was nothing to be heard around but screeches, groans and deep lamentations for

themselves and their families, and earnest cries to G O D for mercy and relief!

THERE was such a croud upon the quarter deck we could not stand up without treading upon one another. Being in a struggle I was thrown down and trampled upon as if the breath would be crowded out of my body: However I soon recovered my feet and trampled upon others in my turn; for the immediate regard which every man had to his own life prevented him from attending to the distresses of his neighbours!

STRUGGLING in this manner and trying to clear ourselves from those who fell down had pulled off most of our shoes, and the wet and cold soon froze our feet. Nature could sustain it no longer and the people began to die all around me. Capt. *John Russell* of *Barnstable* was the first of those with whom I was acquainted that died, but many others soon followed him. Fatigue and distress, added to the extreme cold and despair of relief, put a period to the lives of great numbers. Those who were able to stand were obliged to huddle up close together, and breathe in each other's faces to preserve them from freezing to death, while their comrades were dying around them all night.

In the morning a most awful sight presented itself to us; 60 of our Comrades lay dead across each other, and but 2 of my Townsmen were among the living!

ON Lord's-Day, Dec. 27, the storm abated and the sun appeared clear, but the severe cold still continued. We saw *Plymouth* and a number of people coming along the shore for our relief: We could discern them push off two boats and make an hard trial to come to us, but the harbour was so full of ice they could not reach us: We saw them return and it gave us an inexpressible shock. The elevation which their appearance gave us tended to sink us the lower. Our situation was very gloomy; we had little to support nature except rum; no shoes on our feet, and very much frozen; the Heavens was our only covering!

I RETAINED my senses until about 2 o'clock on Lord's-Day, but was then deprived of them and lay on the quarter-deck until the next day, when a boat got to us in order to carry the living ashore, which amounted only to 32. When they were looking around to collect the survivors, they at first supposed me to be dead, but seeing one of my

eye-lids move they took me up and laying me in the boat carried me ashore.

I WAS carried to Mr. *Bartlet*'s tavern, whose kindness to me I would thus publicly acknowledge, and hope I shall always remember with gratitude. My cloaths were first cut from off me and I was put into cold water in order to take out the frost: I was then placed in bed and having my teeth forced open had some cordials poured down my throat, but I have no remembrance of any of these transactions, for I lay perfectly senseless until 2 o'clock on Monday, when my senses came to me at once. My eyes were not open, but I heard the voices of persons talking around me, and the first idea which struck me was, that I was still on board the brig, but that a boat come to our relief. I soon however opened my eyes and was informed of what had happened and where I then was.

I RECOVERED gradually, but was obliged to pass thro' the painful operation of having some of my limbs separated from my body: But after all these distresses I am still among the living to praise G O D! Let my spared life be devoted to his

service, and may I ever be mindful of his benefits!

Names of the Deceas'd belonging to Barnstable.

Capt. John Russell, Barn. Lothrop, Daniel Hall, Tho. Casley, Eben. Bacon, Jassey Garritt, John Berry, Barnabas Howes, Stephen Bacon, Jon. Lothrop, Boston, a Negro Man.

The SHIPWRECK: A HYMN of Praise.

Deep calleth unto deep at the noise of thy waterspouts: All thy waves and thy billows are gone over me.—Yet the L O R D hath shewn his loving kindness in the day-time: In the night my song shall be with him, and my prayer unto the G O D of my life.—When I remember these things I pour out my soul in me, with the voice of joy and praise. David.

W HEN mountain billows o'er me roll
I poured out my troubled soul
When waves of adverse fortune meet,
Thou prov'd a guide unto my feet.

2. My song shall always be on GOD,
I'm sav'd by his uplifted rod;
My utmost search shall be to know
The LORD who sav'd from frost and snow.

3. LORD may I fear thee all my days,
Thy mercies claim my highest praise;
For in the time of deep despair,
Preserv'd I was by heav'nly care.

4. The LORD is good to those who call
On Him, and do depend for all;
In adverse fate if we depend
On GOD, he will deliv'rance send.

5. In deep distress and trouble fore,
When surging billows round me roar,
Altho' he slay me, yet I'll trust
On GOD, my Saviour, who is just.

6. Not only trust but I will call
On HIM, who is the LORD of all;
My day-long shall in thee accord,
And in the night I'll praise the LORD.

7. Thy goodness and thy tender care
Reliev'd me when in deep despair;
Thy gracious and thy friendly Crook
I will record in this my Book.

8. Had it not been for thy controul,
The deep would swallow up my soul;
Tho' frost me of my feet deprive,
Yet I will praise thee I'm alive.

9. Alive to praise thee, O my G O D,
Tho' chaft'ned with afflicting rod;
But should my fins been marked well,
My soul would have been sent to Hell.

10. But blessed be his holy Hand,
I am return'd to native land;
Tho' sickness did my spirits waste,
Thy flowing mercy I do taste.

11. My Kindred and my Friends so dear;
Trust in the L O R D and always fear
HIM who can save, if you rely
On ONE who rules above the sky.

12. Lo, SEAMEN, one and all attend,
Look well to what I here have pen'd;
Let me intreat you not to swear,
But live in G O D's most holy fear.

13. He will vouchsafe when danger's nigh,
To help, if on HIM you rely;
Tho' storms arise on raging main,
He'll bring thee safe to Friends again.

14. I say to all trust in the L O R D,
He will your grottoes always guard,
From tempests dire and sickness fore;
Your basket fill, and bless your store.

A H Y M N. By another AUTHOR.

MY soul, my powers blest ye the LORD,
With Hymns of praise his wonders
found,

When threat'ning danger round me stood
I sought his help and succour found.

2. Hopeless I saw my gloomy case,
When bursting waves broke o'er my head,
Then did my soul address his throne,
And all its wants before him spread.

3. Then in the mount did GOD appear,
And made his light in darkness shine,
At his rebuke the Tempest fled,
To magnify his arm divine.

4. He said I have a ransom found,
Therefore ye sons of men return,
I will no more with you contend,
Nor let my wrath forever burn.
5. I am the LORD who rules the seas,
My voice can hush the roaring waves,
The keys of death are in my Hand
To shut or open oozy graves.
6. Come trust the LORD in all your straits,
His great salvation call to mind,
My own experience can attest,
The LORD is good, his dealings kind.
7. Within the book of his accounts,
Each of my members written are,
Without commission from his Hand,
There shall not fall a limb or hair.
8. With joyful heart I'll tread his Courts,
And pay my vows among his Saints,
To Him my life, my all devote,
Who bow'd his Ear to my complaints.

Transcriber's Note

Archaic and inconsistent spelling retained, along with inconsistent hyphenation (quarter-deck/quarter deck).

To revert to modern letterforms, globally replace "f" with "s".

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A BRIEF AND
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